



THE LITERARY SCIENTIST

A Multi-Disciplinary Journal for Literature and Science

ISSN: 3048-7366(Online)

<https://theliteraryscientist.org/>

Volume 1

Issue 2

09.02.2025

Paper Title:

Jung's Archetypes and Baum's Attempt at Ethical Neutrality in *The Wizard of Oz*

Author:

Sounak Banerjee

Sounak Banerjee is an accomplished academic and educator known for his specialization in English Language and Literature, particularly in the realm of Children's literature and Mythologies. He earned his Master of Arts degree from the prestigious University of Burdwan.

The Literary Scientist (TLS) A Multi-Disciplinary Journal for Literature and Science follows an Open Access Policy for copyright and licensing. If you are using or reproducing content from this platform, you need to appropriately cite the author(s) and the Journal name



Jung's Archetypes and Baum's Attempt at Ethical Neutrality in The Wizard of Oz

_____Sounak Banerjee

Abstract

The present work attempts a Jungian Archetypal analytical approach to the characters presented by Frank L. Baum in his children's novel The Wizard of Oz. The main protagonist of the novel Dorothy, a child whose journey to the unknown land called Oz depicts a dream sequence and she meets various companions during her journey to come back home. Those companions of Dorothy represent the reflections of various archetypes mentioned by Carl Gustav Jung in his theories of "Archetypes and Collective Unconscious". This present research work will try to apply Jung's speculation for Archetypal analysis to grasp the significance of the characters in the said novel and analyse them further.

Keywords: *Carl Gustav Jung, Frank L. Baum, archetypal analysis, children's literature, The Wizard of Oz*

One of the proponents of Children's Literature, Frank L. Baum's intended and targeted readers might be children yet through a few affiliations and close investigations of the characters created by him in *The Wizard of Oz*, another train of contemplations can be traced back to those characters through Archetypal Criticism. The etymology of the word archetype can be followed back to Plato's *Eidos*. The term 'arche' signifies 'unique' and 'typos' signifies 'form'. The concept of this archetypal literary criticism was popularized in the twentieth century by the Swiss psychologist Carl Gustav Jung (1875-1961). The incorporation of the Collective Unconscious by Jung separates his psychoanalytical methodology from Freud or some other contemporary psychoanalysts. Jung accepted that everyone's dream does not get their significance from sexual affiliations and can have innovative ramifications. He likewise dismisses the idea of 'Oedipus Complex' and 'Electra Complex' in psychosexual stages. Jung accepted that our lived feelings impact the oblivious brain or unconsciousness. The characters in *The Wizard of Oz* end up clarifying the significant components in the crusade against the "Gold Standard" through the portrayal of Jungian archetypal figures. Dorothy, the dreaming innocent, is on a quest for individualization or self-actualization as "The Hero" of the novel. Her companions— Scarecrow, Cowardly Lion, and Tin Woodman— depict three characteristics of Anima which address the "true self" as opposed to 'appearances' that correspond with the collective unconscious. Toto, Dorothy's pet dog portrays the Trickster archetype. The Wizard himself portrays the 'Creator' archetype. Since Dorothy's experience in the novel resembles a dream, and the characters she gets to know during her journey reassemble various archetypes. The present work will endeavour to apply Jung's theories of "Archetypes and Collective Unconscious" (Jung 3-41) to comprehend the influence of archetypes in the legendary children's novel *The Wizard of Oz* and in the process

the work will be giving further elaborations on how Baum attempted to create a children's novel without ethics, brutality or sentimentalism yet failed to do so due to the human unconscious impacted by the ethics of various archetypes.

1. Literature Review

Stanley H. Cath and Claire Cath in their research work titled “On the Other Side of Oz: Psychoanalytic Aspects of Fairy Tales”, talked about the psychological effects embroiled on us through fairy tales, bedtime stories and children’s literature of such. The researchers especially talked about

Frank L. Baum’s *The Wizard of Oz*. They described how a quest for all loving parents affected the whole life of the ‘Heroine’ Dorothy Gale. How the Witches of the West and her minions depict the fear and helplessness of a child was likewise expounded in this research work. In conclusion of the aforementioned work, the researcher says:

Fairy tales seem a desirable accompaniment of the period of life in which a child is progressing to secondary process thinking, which involves concepts of logic, time, animism, space, and causality. As in good therapy or analysis, in creating or sharing fairy tales, the meaning or experience of meaning must be conveyed in a language based on the available conceptual framework and sensitive to the needs for mirroring grandiosity, magic, and dependency (Cath and Cath 638).

Kenneth B. Kidd in his book *Freud in Oz: At the Intersections of Psychoanalysis and Children’s Literature* introduced the connection between children’s literature and psychoanalysis whether it is collaborative or hostile, now and again leaning toward one task or talking over the other. In his book, while he has shared his interests in some new "trauma writing", his fundamental objective

in the said work has been to depict as opposed to assess. His essential undertaking was framing a tale about the authentic experiences of children's literature and psychoanalysis, and consequently proposing new headings for research.

In their research works researchers do not mention any kind of archetypal imagery depicted through the characterism in Frank L. Baum's *The Wizard of Oz* or the influence of collective unconscious upon individuals.

2. Jungian Theories of Archetypes and Collective Unconscious

Jung suggested that the human brain, or mind, is not only the result of individual experience, but instead contains components which are pre-individual, transpersonal, and normal to all. These elements are called the archetypes. Jung recommended that it is their effect on human ideas and conduct that differentiates thought and behaviour in different myths and religions. He recognized the persona, or the picture of ourselves that we present to the world, from our shadow, which might involve hidden anxieties and repressed thoughts. Jung likewise noticed the connection between our unconscious, which contains an individual's very own recollections and thoughts, and a collective unconscious, a bunch of recollections and thoughts that is shared among all of mankind. Shared ideas, which Jung depicted as archetypes, pervade the collective unconscious and arise as subjects and characters in our fantasies and surface in our way of life—in legends, books, movies and artistic creations, for instance. Jung felt that disunity among thoughts in the individual psyche and the conscious could make struggles under the surface which could prompt specific personality traits or anxieties. Jung's process for resolving such inner conflicts is by permitting repressed ideas to arise into the conscious and accommodating them, in this way making a condition of inward congruity, through a procedure

known as individuation.

Notwithstanding the personal unconscious, there is a more profound and more crucial domain of the consciousness which Jung called the collective unconscious. Jung said, “From the unconscious there emanate determining influences... which, independently of tradition, guarantee in every single individual a similarity and even a sameness of experience, and also, of the way it is represented imaginatively” (Jung 58). In simple terms, the collective unconscious comprises ‘psychic structures’ or ‘cognitive categories’ which are not distinctive to the individual, yet rather are shared by all, affecting our contemplations, ways of behaving, and the way we look at the world. In short, this collective unconscious is home to the archetypes. To illustrate the types of symbols which are influenced by the archetypes, Jung mentioned twelve archetypes which are largely influenced by myths and religions and those archetypes control our unconscious all the time. Jungian person paradigms are seen under the shadow of Jung's four significant attributes of the collective unconscious: ‘The Persona’ (Jung 163), ‘The Shadow’ (Jung 284), ‘The Anima or Animus’ (Jung 54), and ‘The Self’ (Jung 268). Jung recognized that the four primary models can intertwine within themselves and bring these twelve archetypal images— Ruler, Creator or artist, Sage, Innocent, Explorer, Rebel, Hero, Wizard, Jester, Everyman, Lover, and Caregiver.

3. World of Oz through the Jungian Spectacles

In the preface to his unfathomable work *The Wizard of Oz*, Frank L. Baum presents his view on children's writing— “Folklore, legends, myths and fairy tales have followed childhood through the ages, for every healthy youngster has a wholesome and instinctive love for stories fantastic, marvellous and manifestly unreal. The winged fairies of Grimm and Andersen have

brought more happiness to childish hearts than all other human creations.” (Baum 3). This demonstrates how individuals are impacted by folklore, myths, fairy tales and children's literature of such from their experiences growing up. Maud Bodkin dismisses the thought that archetypes are “Stamped upon the physical organism” (Bodkin).

I will concentrate on six central characters from this novel to be analyzed by Jung's theory of Archetypes— Dorothy Gale, Toto, The Scarecrow, The Tin Woodman, The Cowardly Lion and ultimately The Wizard of Oz.

3.1. Dorothy

Youthful Dorothy is somewhat of a shut-in. An orphan who is being raised by her auntie and uncle on the dark fields of Kansas, she's accustomed to driving a calm presence. However, when a cyclone gets her whole house and carries it along with her, and her little dog, in a new land called Oz, her life gets significantly seriously energized. In Oz, Dorothy ends up pursuing around a lot of flying monkeys and fiendish witches and hot-air balloons. She is not in any way shape or form dazzled with her everyday existence. What to be aware of Dorothy is that any place she goes, she would be a lot happier than being back in that flimsy farmhouse with her uncle and auntie. Dorothy with her trademark introvert nature is a maverick at the place that is known for Oz. The urbane individuals of Oz cannot exactly sort out what she finds in it, the scarecrow pays attention to her and afterwards says— "I cannot understand why you should wish to leave this beautiful country and go back to the dry, gray place you call Kansas" (Baum 20). Dorothy replied— "No matter how dreary and gray our homes are, we people of flesh and blood would rather live there than in any other country, be it ever so beautiful. There is no place like home" (Baum 20). A transformation of the psyche is noticed when she misses the brief life she

despised.

Dorothy is the “The Hero” of the novel. The Jungian Hero Archetype is related to the most common way of defeating hardships to accomplish indicated objectives. As per Carl Jung, the hero's objective in fantasies is much of the time to track down a fortune, like a golden egg, save a princess, and return to the wellspring of youth. Jung says— “The hero's main feat is to overcome the monster of darkness: it is the long-hoped-for and expected triumph of consciousness over the unconscious. Day and light are synonyms for consciousness, night and dark for the unconscious” (Jung 167).

3.2. Toto

Let's take Toto, the dog Dorothy's canine confidant for example; Baum describes him:

It was Toto that made Dorothy laugh, and saved her from growing as gray as her other surroundings. Toto was not gray; he was a little black dog, with long, silky hair and small black eyes that twinkled merrily on either side of his funny, wee nose. Toto played all day long, and Dorothy played with him, and loved him dearly (Baum 8).

Toto is the only ray of sunshine who makes her laugh when she is mentally upset by her auntie's carelessness about her prosperity or adolescence.

Carl Jung's “Trickster Archetype” suits Toto's character perfectly, Jung describes Trickster as “an archetypal psychic structure of extreme antiquity. In his clearest manifestations, he is a faithful reflection of an absolutely undifferentiated human consciousness, corresponding to a psyche that has hardly left the animal level” (Jung 260). Jung described the trickster as “If, at the end of the trickster myth, the saviour is hinted at, this comforting premonition or hope means that

some calamity or other has happened and been consciously understood” (Jung 271).

3.3. The Scarecrow

The Scarecrow fits the description of “The Caregiver” archetype, theorized by Carl Jung. Jung explains how this character of the caregiver also known as the “Mother Archetype” offers their heart straightforwardly and energetically, and stretches out any energy they can to assist the legend with prevailing on their mission. Fast to pardon and empower, the Caregiver offers characters tired from an extensive stretch of strain a welcome reprieve, such as friendship, medical services, or everyday encouragement. Once in a while, it is the presence of the Caregiver or even the memory of that Caregiver, that keeps those who would somehow tumble from surrendering. Since not everything is terrible on the planet, and if nothing else, their adoration is a sureness. To explain the qualities of a Mother archetype Jung says:

“The qualities associated with it are maternal solicitude and sympathy; the magic authority of the female; the wisdom and spiritual exaltation that transcend reason; any helpful instinct or impulse; all that is benign, all that cherishes and sustains, that fosters growth and fertility. The place of magic transformation and rebirth, together with the underworld and its inhabitants, are presided over by the mother” (Jung 82).

While the Scarecrow does not appear to see his own brilliance, his companions sure do. "That is a first-rate idea," says the Lion at one point. "One would almost suspect you had brains in your head, instead of straw" (Baum 35). The Wizard, too, provides insight into the Scarecrow's situation. "Experience is the only thing that brings knowledge," he says, "and the longer you are on earth the more experience you are sure to get" (Baum 80).

3.4. The Tin Woodman

Tin Woodman is a prime example of “The Everyperson” archetype once in a while alluded to as the Orphan, the great neighbour, the quiet larger part, the esteemed gentleman, the silent majority, the good old boy, the common man, or the person next door, the Everyperson is a smidgen of you, a tad of me, and a tad of every other person, as well. The Everyperson remains on neutral ground with every last bit of her companions and is anxious to fabricate new and enduring associations with each of the characters that populate her reality. To be acknowledged by her picked peers is important for Everyperson's desires. And keeping in mind that having a place with a family, a gathering, a nation, or an experience spurs the person in question to succeed, the ceaseless longing for acknowledgement can likewise prompt loss of self in the work to please so many others.

3.5. The Cowardly Lion

The Cowardly lion fits “The Innocent” archetype in every aspect of his existence. Known by many other names, including the Child, the Youth, Utopian, naive, and mystic, the Innocent epitomizes all that we wish to get back to in old age and a spirit clean from the cruelty of the world. Carl Jung describes:

The child motif represents not only something that existed in the distant past but also something that exists now; that is to say, it is not just a vestige but a system functioning in the present whose purpose is to compensate or correct, in a meaningful manner, the inevitable one-sidedness and extravagances of the conscious mind (Jung 162).

The Innocent hunger for happiness regardless of anything else. It need not be only his own; the Innocent desires heaven for all, for his adversary too. The inspirations for the Innocent are true. Truth is all he knows. This pure blamelessness makes this archetype perhaps of the most

thoughtful person, and in social environments, the Innocent frequently revitalizes those sooner down-trampled. They move individuals to default to the upside, particularly those that are indifferent. At his level, the Innocent can persuade an impartial party to battle for the Hero, regardless of whether there is no prize to be had and the likelihood of coming out on top is thin. His hopefulness is unmatched.

3.6. The Wizard of Oz

The Wizard of Oz is not a wizard by any means. He is simply some guy from Nebraska. Similar to Dorothy, he came to Oz unintentionally. Be that as it may, rather than attempting to get back home, he remained and tricked individuals, and presently those awful decisions are at long last finding him. He had the option to remain in power for such a long time because he cautiously developed a demeanour of secret. He seldom gives individuals access to his royal chamber to limit the possibility of getting found out. For a period, this methodology works. On the way to Oz, one person tells Dorothy "nor do I know of any living person who has seen him" (Baum 46). Nor does anyone seem to know what he looks like. "Oz is a Great Wizard and can take on any form he wishes...

Who the real Oz is, when he is in his own form, no living person can tell" (Baum 46-47)? Oz, when he shows up in various structures to Dorothy and every one of her companions maintains that veil of secrecy by all means. However, the wizard isn't mysterious, he is adroit. He right away determines the Scarecrow, the Tin Woodman, and the Lion as having confidence issues. In any case, since the companions have their hearts set on the prizes they were guaranteed, and the Wizard is a fraud, at any rate, he chooses to humour them. He gives them a fake brain, a fake heart, and fake courage, respectively, and his gifts instantly do the trick. "How can I help being a

humbug," he said, "when all these people make me do things that everybody knows can't be done" (Baum 83)? His words suggest that, while Oz was guilty of tricking the people of Oz, the people themselves bear some of the blame.

The Wizard of Oz illuminates "The Creator" archetype theorized by Jung. The Creator conveys a limitless creative mind, frequently succeeding at their picked work. While introduced as a human person in a reality-based world, he is in many cases depicted as a man somewhat revolutionary. Also known as the artist, innovator, inventor, architect, musician, artist, and dreamer, The Creator is exclusively centred on looking at the limits of our existence and discernment.

4. Conclusion

Baum's acknowledged expectations with the Oz books and his other fairy tales were to retell stories tracked down by the Grimm Brothers and Hans Christian Andersen in a modern American way. He precluded cliché characters like midgets or genies and eliminated the relationship of viciousness and moral lessons. Another customary component that Baum purposefully precluded was the accentuation of romance. He believed ardent love to be tedious to children, who are the primary target readers of this novel. In *The Wizard of Oz*, the main components of the sentiment of love are laid in the background of the Tin Woodman and his reverence for Nimmie Amee. He needed to break the stereotypes of the literary style and framework of an old-fashioned children's novel. Those literary works conveyed a moral, an educative opinion with their characters and subjects,

Baum simply wanted to compose something that would bring happiness to the readers. Be that as it may, in the process he followed the archetypes set by the human culture for making

his characters in the novel. Indeed, he said he wanted to write stories to convey unadulterated bliss however, that is the thing Jung says in his hypothesis of "Archetypes and Collective Unconscious" (Jung 3-41) human unconscious is unknowingly impacted by the "Archetypes" he referenced. Human's creative premises are likewise impacted by those as well. In spite of his effort to convey happiness to the readers, he was unwittingly passing the ethics of the archetypes on through the characters in *The Wizard of Oz*.

References

- Baum, Frank, et al. *The Wonderful World of Oz: The Wizard of Oz, The Emerald City of Oz, Glinda of Oz* (Classic, 20th-Century, Penguin). Annotated, Penguin Classics, 1998.
- Bodkin, Maud. *Archetypal Patterns in Poetry: Psychological Studies of Imagination* (Oxford Paperbacks No. 66). Oxford University Press, 1963.
- Cath, Stanley H., and Claire Cath. "On the Other Side of Oz." *The Psychoanalytic Study of the Child*, vol. 33, no. 1, 1978, pp. 621–39. Crossref, doi:10.1080/00797308.1978.11822993.
- Jung, C., et al. *Alchemical Studies* (Collected Works of C.G. Jung Vol.13). 1st Edition, Princeton University Press, 1983.
- Jung, C., et al. *Four Archetypes: Mother / Rebirth / Spirit / Trickster* (Bollingen). Princeton University Press, 1971.
- Jung, C. *The Collected Works of C. G. Jung, Vol. 7: Two Essays on Analytical Psychology*. 1st ed., Routledge, 1967.
- Jung, Carl Gustav, et al. *The Collected Works of C. G. Jung, Vol. 9, Part 1: The Archetypes*

and the Collective Unconscious (Bollingen Series, No. 20). 2nd ed., Princeton University Press, 1969.

Kidd, Kenneth. *Freud in Oz: At the Intersections of Psychoanalysis and Children's Literature*. 1st ed., Univ Of Minnesota Press, 2011.